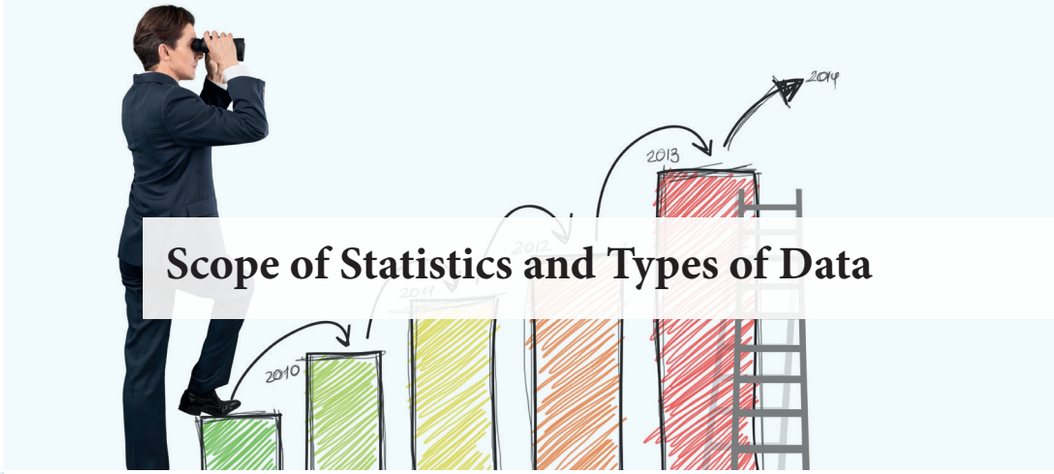
Chapter

1



Scope of Statistics and Types of Data



Prsanta Chandra Mahalanobis
(29 June, 1893-28 June, 1972)

P C Mahalanobis, known as father of Indian Statistics, received his early schooling at the Brahmo Boys School and graduation in Physics in 1912 through Presidency college, Kolkata. He left for England in1913 for higher studies at University of London. Mahalanobis was introduced to the journal Biometrika, that motivated him for the interest in statistics. A statistical laboratory was developed by him at Presidency College and later this formed the foundation for the famous Indian Statistical Institute at Kolkata. One of his important contribution was in designing and conducting large scale surveys. He introduced the concept of pilot surveys and advocated the usefulness of sampling methods.

DO YOU KNOW?

June 29th the birth anniversary of **P.C. Mahalanobis** is commemorated as the National Statistics Day of India.

'Statistics is the grammar of science' *-Karl Pearson*

Learning Objectives

- Highlights the origin and growth of statistics
- Introduces the meaning and definitions of statistics
- Presents the scope and functions of statistics
- Explains the applications of statistics in different fields
- Introduces the meaning of data
- Distinguishes the different types of data

B12SKS

Introduction

In this unit, we present the meaning of statistics, various definitions, origin and growth, functions, scope and applications to different fields such as Agriculture, Economics and many more. We also define 'data', various types of data and their measurement scales.

Ch1_11th Stats.indd 1 2/3/2019 10:56:29 AM